

Values-Led Problem Statement

Latent Probing for Mental Health Sentiment Classification

Many individuals experiencing psychological distress do not receive timely support because early signs of struggle, expressed subtly in everyday language, often go unnoticed until a crisis emerges. This is especially true for people who avoid seeking help due to stigma or limited access to care, leaving families, communities, and overstretched mental health systems reacting only after harm has occurred. Our project uses latent probing techniques to detect mental health sentiment patterns in text, aiming to support, not replace, early identification efforts. The solution is guided by privacy, safety, fairness, and transparency, ensuring sensitive data is protected, model outputs remain interpretable, and performance stays equitable across diverse populations. By keeping human judgment central to any decision, we hope to help connect at-risk individuals with support earlier, fostering a safer, less stigmatizing, and more responsive approach to mental health care.